

HANEUL YI

Assistant Professor of Business Administration · Truman State University

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Truman State University
Assistant Professor of Business Administration

August 2025 – Present
Kirksville, Missouri

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University
Ph.D. in Finance

August 2025
College Station, Texas

Yonsei University
Ph.D. in Finance — coursework completed

July 2019
Seoul, Korea

Yonsei University
B.B.A. in Business Administration

2012
Seoul, Korea

Institut Supérieur du Commerce de Paris
Exchange student program (one year)

2009
Paris, France

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Innovation Economics · Corporate Venture Capital · Mergers and Acquisitions · Sustainable Finance · Textual Analysis · Machine Learning · Labor Economics

WORKING PAPERS

1. When Pressure to Be Green Becomes Demand for Green Credentials (*with Kangryun Lee*)

JOB MARKET PAPER

Abstract. A firm under environmental regulation is recorded twice. The regulator records whether a plant met the condition written into its permit, and the audience that evaluates the firm keeps a separate record that ranks firms and credits what the firm has in place. We ask whether firms under regulatory pressure respond by buying green technology that moves the audience's record and not the regulator's. We use the 2005 designation of fine particulate nonattainment counties under the Clean Air Act, measuring exposure from the share of a firm's pre-shock air emissions originating at plants in counties later designated, and we identify a green acquisition from the target's own granted green patents, so the label does not depend on the acquirer's stated motive or the target's industry. Exposed firms become 4.08 percentage points more likely to acquire a target holding green technology, against a base rate of 2.86 percent, and we find no rise in overall acquisition activity. The increase is concentrated in climate and clean energy technology, acquisitions of air-pollution abatement technology show no detectable response, and the increase is larger at firms that more analysts follow. Following the deals the firm's environmental rating rises, while we detect no reduction in emissions and no reorientation of the acquirer's own invention. The targets and the patents are real, so what we document is not a divergence between what a firm says and what it does. It is a divergence between what the firm holds and what the regulation was written to change.

PRESENTATIONS: SWFA 2025

2. Try Before You Buy: Measuring Innovation Synergy Using Textual Analysis

Abstract. An increasing number of acquirers make corporate venture capital (CVC) investments in private firms before acquiring them, a “two-step merger” strategy. Using textual analysis of patents within a real-options framework, I trace this strategy across three stages. Before the CVC, acquirers are more likely to invest in targets whose technology is more opaque, consistent with CVC as a way to gather information under uncertainty. After the CVC, pairs with greater technological alignment are more likely to proceed to an M&A. After the merger, acquirers that previously invested via CVC expand their technological scope, and patents filed by target and acquirer inventors share more newly aligned keywords and closer thematic similarity than in withdrawn deals. CVC thus serves as a real option that lays the groundwork for innovation synergy in later M&A.

PRESENTATIONS: Texas A&M University Brownbag Series; Texas A&M University PG&E Corporation Distinguished Lecture Series; SFA 2025; MFA 2026

3. Choosing Twice: What the Contract Does Not Transfer in the Acquisition of Innovation

Abstract. An acquisition of an innovative firm conveys patents under the purchase agreement and the inventors who produced them under no comparable obligation. A corporation that had invested in the target before bidding has observed it from inside and knows more about what it buys than an outside acquirer. Using this variation in corporate venture capital, the paper asks whether an acquirer’s prior information shows in which target it selects and which of a target’s inventors it retains. Across 29,022 inventors in 2,517 acquisitions of venture-backed firms from 1981 to 2022, acquirers with prior stakes select better targets, more highly cited and technologically more distant, and the pattern holds where no corporation held a stake, so it reflects the acquiring firm. Overall, these acquirers retain about as many of the target’s inventors as other buyers, and the difference, 50.3 percent against 42.9, is not significant. The shortfall is confined to the top-ranked inventors who hold most of the technology, who are 14.9 percentage points less likely to be retained. Prior information improves which target an acquirer selects but not which of its inventors it keeps.

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. AI CAPEX and Innovation: Evidence from GPU Adoption (*with Raymond Kim*)

Abstract. Firms that buy AI computing capacity may substitute purchased methods for methods they would otherwise have invented. Using firm-level adoption of graphics processing units, we find that adoption reduces internal process patenting while total patenting, product patenting, research budgets, and inventor headcount are unchanged. The contraction is broad rather than confined to the methods purchased, and it operates at the extensive margin of adoption.

2. Who Mimics? Leaders, Followers, and the Decline of Capital Structure Peer Effects (*previously circulated as “How Uncertainty Shapes Peer Effects in Capital Structure”*)

Abstract. Extending Leary and Roberts (2014) to a 1975 to 2023 sample, this paper documents heterogeneity in capital-structure peer effects. Firms that lead their industry show no measurable response to peers while followers respond strongly, and the decline in the aggregate peer effect after 2000 is accounted for by the entry of firms that do not mimic rather than by a change among incumbents. Work in progress.

PRESENTATIONS: Texas A&M University Brownbag Series

3. Common Ownership of Corporate Venture Capital and the Economic Value of Innovation

PRESENTATIONS: Texas A&M University Brownbag Series

SUPPORT: Mays Innovation Research Center Ph.D. Paper Award / Grant

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Truman State University — Instructor

- Personal Finance — Fall 2025 (in person), Spring 2026 (hybrid), Fall 2026 (asynchronous online)
- Principles of Finance — Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026
- Financial Modeling and Valuation (formerly Seminar in Finance) — Spring 2026

Texas A&M University — Instructor

- Survey of Finance Principles (business minor core, asynchronous online) — Spring 2022, Summer 2022, Fall 2022, Summer 2023, Fall 2024

Texas A&M University — Teaching Assistant

- Investment Analysis — Prof. Philipp Illeditsch, Spring 2024

- International Finance — Prof. Marco Rossi, Summer 2022
- Valuation — Prof. Adam Kolasinski, Spring 2020, Spring 2021

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Dean's Award for Outstanding Teaching by a Doctoral Student, Texas A&M University	2022–2023
Mays Innovation Research Center Ph.D. Paper Award / Grant	April 2021
Mays Ph.D. Enhancement Fellowship, Texas A&M University	2019–2025
Finance Department Fellowship, Texas A&M University	2019–2025

SERVICE

Advisor, CFA Research Challenge Competition	2026-2027
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Korea Development Institute (KDI) <i>Research Associate, Financial Policy Research Department</i>	June 2017 – June 2018 <i>Sejong, Korea</i>
H English <i>Founder and Instructor</i>	January 2010 – July 2019 <i>Seoul, Korea</i>
STX Heavy Industries <i>Assistant Manager, Project Finance Team</i>	June 2012 – July 2013 <i>Seoul, Korea</i>
Deutsche Bank Korea <i>Intern, Trade Finance Team</i>	January 2012 – March 2012 <i>Seoul, Korea</i>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Stata · R · Python · $\text{\LaTeX}$

REFERENCES

Prof. Shane A. Johnson (Co-Chair)
Thomas W. Leland Memorial Chair
Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance
Mays Business School, Texas A&M University
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